

Habibou IBRAHIM KASSOUM

ECONOMIST | STATISTICIAN | DATA SCIENTIST

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Profile Summary

Current position: Economist - Statistician (The World Bank) & Ph.D. Research Fellow in Economics.

Work experience countries: France, Malawi, Mauritania, Niger, Senegal, Uganda, USA.

Economist & Statistician with over 5 years of experience working with both household and administrative data across 5+ countries in Sub-Saharan Africa. Currently a Ph.D. Research Fellow in Economics and MIT MicroMasters graduate, with hands-on experience designing and deploying microsimulation tools to assess the distributional impact of fiscal policies. Proficient in STATA, R, and Python, with strong experience in Git-based collaborative coding workflows. Fully bilingual (English/French) with a demonstrated ability to translate complex quantitative findings into actionable policy recommendations for diverse multicultural teams and government stakeholders.

Work Experience

Eastern & Southern Africa Poverty Department - The World Bank

Washington, D.C., USA

ECONOMIST - STATISTICIAN (FIXED-TERM CONTRACT)

Feb. 2025 - Present

Contributed to the **\$15 million** Malawi Statistical Capacity Building Project (STATCAP). Conducted **fiscal incidence analysis** and developed a **microsimulation** tool to assess distributional impacts of fiscal policies.

- Designed and deployed a client-oriented microsimulation web application to assess poverty and inequality impacts of fiscal policy changes, informing government policy reforms.
- Trained 35 government economists across 3 ministries in microsimulation modeling and data analysis techniques during a month-long in-country mission to Malawi, strengthening institutional capacity for policy.
- Updated Malawi's national poverty line through microeconomic analysis of household consumption data, enhancing poverty assessment accuracy and optimizing targeting efficiency of social protection transfers.

Centre d'Études et de Recherches sur le Développement International (CERDI)

Clermont-Ferrand, France

PH.D. RESEARCH FELLOW IN ECONOMICS (FIXED-TERM CONTRACT)

Sept. 2023 - Present

Evaluated Sub-Saharan development programs targeting poverty using **microeconomic analysis and household survey data**. Analyzed multi-country data to drive policy recommendations for governments.

- Produced subnational poverty and food security maps for all Sub-Saharan African countries using machine learning in R and Python, enabling targeted resource allocation and regional development planning.
- Evaluated the **\$45 million** multi-sectoral social protection program in Mauritania, combining cash transfers with livelihood support, using impact evaluation methods to inform scalable interventions across the region.
- Built capacity in quantitative analysis and statistical programming by training students and professionals in STATA, R and Python, with a focus on data-driven decision making and reproducible research practices.

UMR Aix-Marseille School of Economics (AMSE)

Marseille, France

RESEARCH ECONOMIST - DATA ANALYST (FIXED-TERM CONTRACT)

Sept. 2022 - Aug. 2023

Conducted **microeconomic research** to inform evidence-based policy on poverty reduction, food security, and migration across Sub-Saharan Africa, enhancing human capital development and living standards.

- Analyzed 12,500+ household records across 2 LSMS and 15 DHS surveys covering 245 million population across African countries (Benin, Cameroon, Nigeria) to generate poverty profiles informing policy targeting.
- Led statistical research quantifying the impact of socio-cultural factors on migration and poverty outcomes, generating new evidence on drivers of mobility and specific social protection needs essential for building resilience.
- Developed automated Python pipelines for cross-country household survey data integration, streamlining comparative analysis and reducing reporting time by 75%.

French Research Institute for Development (IRD)

Marseille, France

RESEARCH ECONOMIST - DATA ANALYST (INTERNSHIP)

Apr. 2022 - Aug. 2022

Estimated socioeconomic impacts of the 2014 Ebola pandemic across West Africa using **microeconomic methods and household survey data** to assess distributional effects on poverty and evaluate emergency aid effectiveness.

- Analyzed WHO Ebola outbreak data across 3 West African countries using STATA and R, evaluating distributional socioeconomic impacts on vulnerable populations to inform poverty alleviation responses.
- Analyzed aid allocation and resource efficiency mechanisms using statistical analysis to optimize humanitarian assistance targeting in crisis-affected regions, providing analytical support for improved crisis preparedness.
- Delivered research findings and evidence-based policy recommendations to senior researchers, directly contributing to strategies for health emergency preparedness systems and enhancing regional resilience to shocks.

Contributed to the **\$40.5 million** EHCVM project for national poverty measurement. Built government capacity in **data collection** modernization using advanced survey methodology and sampling design.

- Processed 7,000 household records for EHCVM data representing 16 million people using inferential statistics and regression analysis for evidence-based policy making and resource allocation.
- Built national household survey application using SurveyCTO, streamlining field operations and improving data quality by 40%.
- Developed automated R and Python visualization and reporting scripts processing poverty and inequality indicators, enabling real-time data-driven decision making and optimizing targeting of development resources.

Assisted Niger’s poverty monitoring system, focusing on food security and undernutrition indicators. Estimated official undernutrition rates and conducted **data quality** assessments to inform evidence-based policymaking.

- Processed national nutrition survey data to generate poverty and food security indicators that informed targeted government interventions across rural and urban populations.
- Implemented data quality assessments on household survey datasets, strengthening national statistics reliability for policy dialogue.
- Formulated technical guidelines for undernutrition and food security assessment methodologies, enhancing national institutional capabilities for data-driven poverty reduction policy formulation.

Education

- Topic: Essays on Poverty, Nutrition, and Social Protection in Fragile and Conflict-Affected Settings.
- Thesis supervision: Pascale PHELINAS (CERDI,UCA,IRD) & Jordan LOPER (CERDI,UCA).

Skills

- ArcGIS, Git, LaTeX, MS Office, MySQL, Python, QGIS, R, SQL, SQL Server, Stata, Survey Solution.

Languages

- English: fluent speaking, reading, and writing.
- French: native fluency in speaking, reading, and writing.
- Hausa and Zarma: mother tongue.
- Wolof and Arabic: basic.

Certification

Rigorous training in microeconomic methods, and data analysis for poverty reduction. (See certificate).

Volunteering

Conducted community initiatives and provided support for Nigerien residents in Clermont-Ferrand.

Analyzed donation tools, campaigns, and website content to enhance fundraising efforts for CAMAAY.

References

- Lina CARDONA SOSA (The World Bank): Senior Economist; lcardonasosa@worldbank.org; (+1) 202-948-4589.
- Pascale PHELINAS (UCA, CERDI, IRD): Research Director; pascale.phelinas@uca.fr; (+33) 04-73-17-74-17.
- Jordan LOPER (UCA, CERDI): Associate Professor; Jordan.LOPER@uca.fr; (+33) 04-73-17-74-23.